

Problem Set 6

Hoa T. Vu

Discrete Probability

Problem 1: Card Draw. A standard deck has 52 cards: 4 suits (clubs, diamonds, hearts, spades), each with 13 ranks (2–10, J, Q, K, A). Two cards are drawn *without replacement*.

- (a) What is the probability that both cards are hearts?
- (b) What is the probability that the two cards have the same rank?
- (c) Let A = “first card is an ace” and B = “second card is an ace”. Are A and B independent? Justify your answer.
- (d) Given that the first card drawn is an ace, what is the probability that the second card is also an ace?

Problem 2: Linearity of Expectation.

- (a) A fair die is rolled 10 times. Let X be the total sum. Compute $\mathbb{E}[X]$.
- (b) A deck of 52 cards is shuffled uniformly at random. A card is a **match** if it lands in position i and has rank $i \bmod 13$. Let X be the number of matches. Compute $\mathbb{E}[X]$.
Hint: use indicator random variables.
- (c) You roll a fair die repeatedly until you see a 6. Let $X_i = 1$ if roll i is not a 6, and 0 otherwise. Explain why computing $\mathbb{E}[\text{number of non-6 rolls before the first 6}]$ via linearity of expectation is *not* straightforward here, and state what additional tool would be needed.

Bloom Filters

Problem 3: Implementing a Bloom Filter.

Generate the dataset S as follows:

```

import numpy as np
rng = np.random.default_rng(42)

lo = rng.integers(0, 500_000, size=500_000)
hi = rng.integers(1_000_000, 1_500_000, size=500_000)
S = set(np.concatenate([lo, hi]).tolist()) # ~1M inserted elements

```

Using the parameters derived in lecture ($k = \lceil \log_2(1/\varepsilon) \rceil$, $m = \lceil n \log_2(1/\varepsilon) / \ln 2 \rceil$), implement a Bloom filter and answer the following.

Use the following hash family:

```

def _mix(x, seed, m):
    x = (x ^ seed) & 0xffffffff
    x = ((x ^ (x >> 16)) * 0x45d9f3b) & 0xffffffff
    x = ((x ^ (x >> 16)) * 0x45d9f3b) & 0xffffffff
    return ((x ^ (x >> 16)) & 0xffffffff) % m

def hashes(x, k, m):
    return [_mix(x, i * 0x9e3779b9, m) for i in range(k)]

```

To get different hash functions, use different seeds k .

- Implement `BloomFilter(n, eps)` that supports `insert(x)` and `query(x)` using hashes above.
- Insert all elements of S into the filter. Verify there are **no false negatives**: every element of S must return `True` on `query`.
- Generate 10^5 test integers uniformly at random from $[500\,001, 999\,999]$ (the gap between the two inserted ranges — guaranteed not in S). Query each one and report the **empirical false positive rate**.
- Repeat part (c) for $\varepsilon \in \{0.10, 0.05, 0.01, 0.001\}$. For each setting, record the theoretical ε , the empirical rate, and the values of k and m used. Present your results in a table.
- Does doubling m/n roughly square the false positive rate in your experiments? Show the relevant rows from your table and comment.

Problem 4: Bloom Filter with Deletions.

A standard Bloom filter cannot support deletions: clearing a bit when removing x might destroy information about other inserted elements that hash to the same position.

- Explain with a concrete example why clearing a bit on deletion is incorrect. Use $k = 2$, $m = 8$, and two elements x, y that share a hash position.
- Explain how to modify vanilla Bloom filters to handle deletions.